LAUNCHNIK

Live Performance Controller

Operation Manual

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zapperment

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Disclaimer

The project maintainer is in no way associated with Novation, nor Reason Studios, nor Ableton, nor Lectric Panda. Company and product names are trademarks of their respective owners.

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The project maintainer cannot be held accountable for any problems with your music production or performance setup that may be caused by this software.

Requirements

What do you need to play with Launchnik?

Reason 14

Launchnik will *not* work with Reason versions prior to version 14!

Player Sequencer or Dr. Octo Rex

Launchnik is designed to work with Player sequencer devices, like PolyStep, Chord Sequencer, Pattern Mutator, Bassline Generator, Drum Sequencer, etc. Sadly, none of these are included in basic versions of Reason, or Reason Free. They *are* all available if you have a Reason+ subscription, or are proud owner of Reason Complete.

An affordable and good Player that works with Launchnik is Kompulsion by Lectric Panda.

Dr. Octo Rex Loop Player, which *is* included in Reason (not Reason Free) also works with Launchnik.

Introduction

The Reason rack extension Launchnik is a live performance controller, tailor-made to work in tandem with the hardware MIDI controller *Novation Launchpad Pro [MK3]*.

Its core feature is an 8x8 grid of launch buttons. By clicking a launch button — or better, by tapping the corresponding pad on your Launchpad — you can launch clips, which means emitting up to six separate CV voltages to control player patterns and virtually any parameter of any Reason rack device that is connected to Launchnik via CV cables.

This happens in time with your music at a configurable switch interval, e.g. every four bars. Visual feedback shows which clip is playing, which clip has been queued, and when the next switch will happen.

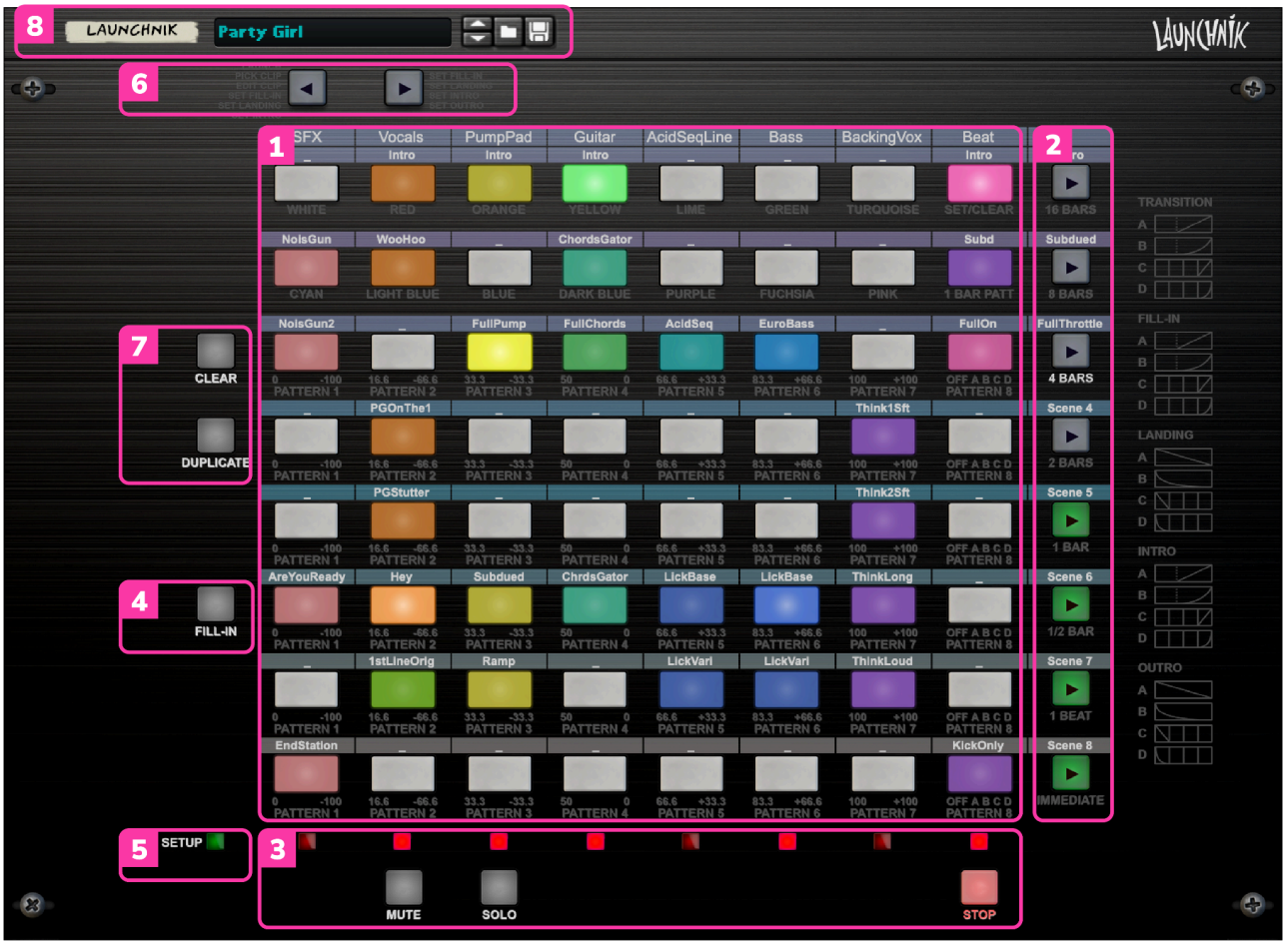
If you are familiar with the session view of Ableton Live, you will immediately recognise this:

The idea of Launchnik is to perform live sets with Reason as stand-alone DAW, even though Reason has no session view of its own!

I hope you'll have as much fun jamming with Launchnik as I do... Cheers, Patrick (Launchnik maker)

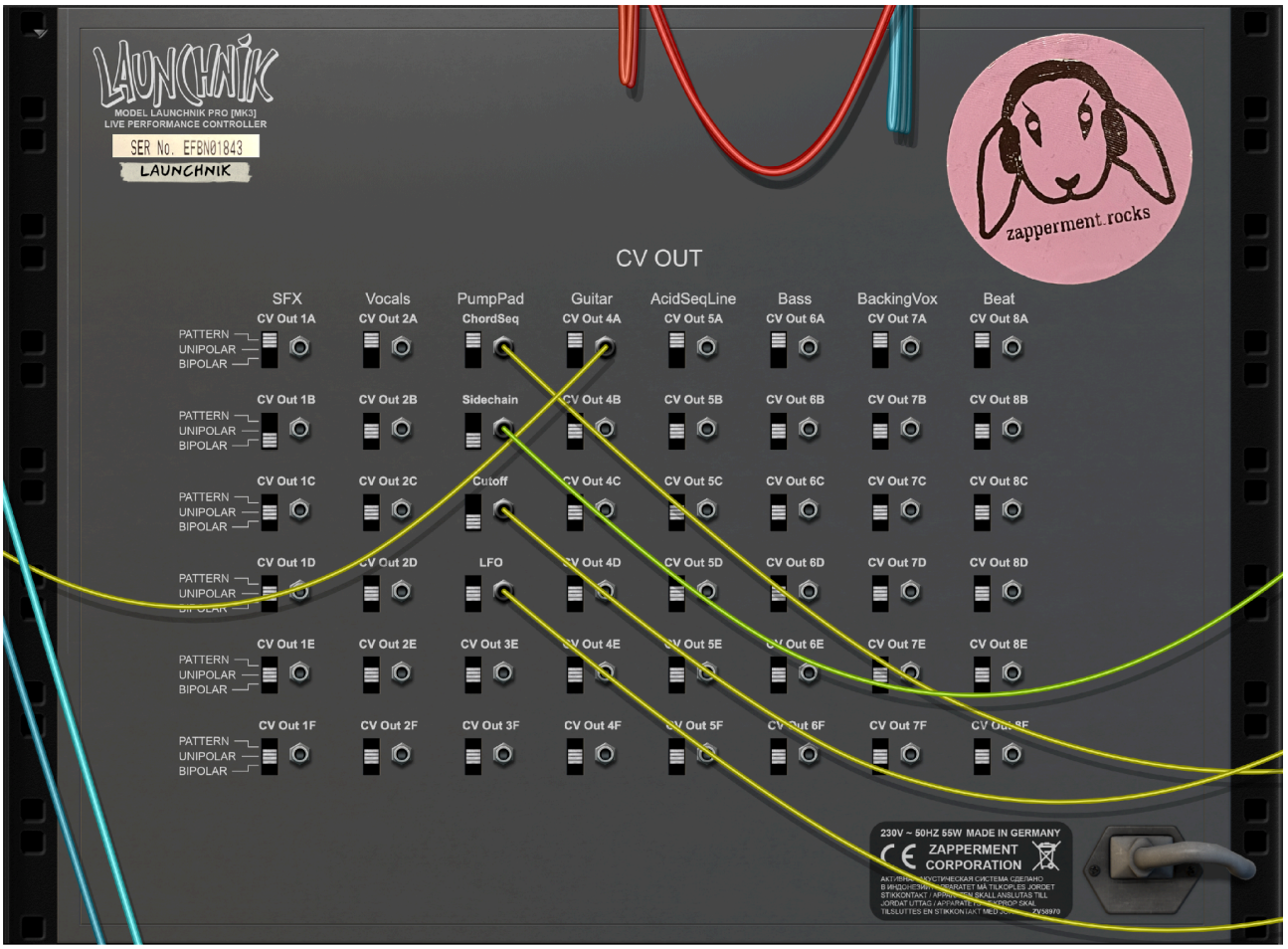
Panel Overview

Front Panel



1. **Launch buttons** — launch clips in launch mode; in setup mode, these buttons act as user interface for configuring colour, pattern, CV values and transitions of clips
2. **Scene buttons** — trigger a row of clips simultaneously; button colours indicate current switch interval position; in setup mode, these allow you to set the length of the switch interval
3. **Track functions** — mute, solo or stop each track (i.e. column of the launch button grid), in time with your music
4. **Fill-in button** — trigger clip variations for drum fills, risers, breaks, etc.
5. **Setup button** — put Launchnik and your Launchpad in setup mode to configure colour, pattern, CV values and transitions of clips
6. **Setup navigation buttons** — step through setup mode pages
7. **Edit buttons** — clear or duplicate clips
8. **Device name and patch selector** — works the same as on any other Reason rack device

Back Panel



Flip the Reason rack with the tab key to access Launchnik's back panel.

Each track (= column of launch buttons) has six CV output jacks to connect rack devices such as Combinators.

Each CV output has three modes of operation:

1. **Pattern** — emits CV voltage in eight steps; this is perfect for controlling patterns of Reason's player devices such as PolyStep Sequencer, Drum Sequencer, Bassline Generator or Pattern Mutator
2. **Unipolar** — emits CV voltage from 0 to 1, for controlling parameters of connected devices directly; use this, for example, to set individual filter cutoff frequencies per clip of a synthesizer to have variations with dark, subdued sound and harsher, brighter sound
3. **Bipolar** — emits CV voltage from -1 to 1; a typical use case is to connect these to the Control CV In jacks of a Combinator, to trim the value of its rotary controls

Connecting Your Launchpad to Launchnik

> ***Please note:*** *It **is** possible to use Launchnik without a Launchpad — just not as much fun. If you don't have a Launchpad, or just want to try out Launchnik quickly, you can skip this section.*
>
> *For now, only the Launchpad model "Pro [MK3]" is supported, because that's all the developer has in his studio.*

To use your Novation Launchpad Pro [MK3] with Launchnik, you need to install a remote codec and its corresponding remote map. A remote codec is a kind of software driver that "tells" Reason how to connect to your hardware.

Download the zip file of the latest release of the remote codec here:

- github.com/zapperment/rebridge/releases/download/lppmk3-latest/Launchpad-Pro-MK3-remote-codec-for-Launchnik.zip

What Is in the Zip File?

- `readme.txt` installation instructions (same as what you are reading right now)
- `Remote/Codecs/Lua Codecs/Novation/LPPMK3.lua` the codec
- `Remote/Codecs/Lua Codecs/Novation/LPPMK3.luacodec` the codec's description
- `Remote/Codecs/Lua Codecs/Novation/LPPMK3.png` the picture Reason shows
- `Remote/Maps/Novation/LPPMK3.remotemap` the remote map

Installing on a Mac

1. Quit Reason.

2. In the Finder, choose the menu item *Go → Go to Folder...* and enter:
   `~/Library/Application Support/Propellerhead Software`
   (the Library folder is hidden; *Go to Folder* gets you there anyway)

3. If there is no folder named `Remote` in it, create one.

> ***Do not drag the zip's Remote folder onto the existing one!***
> *The Finder would replace the folder, and with it any other codecs and maps you have installed.*

4. Copy the files from the zip into the folder `Remote`, preserving the folder structure:

   - `LPPMK3.lua`, `LPPMK3.luacodec` and `LPPMK3.png` go to:
     `Remote/Codecs/Lua Codecs/Novation`
   - `LPPMK3.remotemap` goes to:
     `Remote/Maps/Novation`

Create any of these folders that do not exist yet.

Installing on Windows

1. Quit Reason.

2. In File Explorer, click the address bar, enter the following and press Enter:
   `%APPDATA%\Propellerhead Software`
   (the app data folder is hidden; typing the address gets you there anyway)

3. If there is no folder named `Remote` in it, create one.

> ***Do not drag the zip's Remote folder onto the existing one!***
> *The File Explorer would replace the folder, and with it any other codecs and maps you have installed.*

4. Copy the files from the zip into the folder `Remote`, preserving the folder structure:

   - `LPPMK3.lua`, `LPPMK3.luacodec` and `LPPMK3.png` go to:
     `Remote/Codecs/Lua Codecs/Novation`
   - `LPPMK3.remotemap` goes to:
     `Remote/Maps/Novation`

Create any of these folders that do not exist yet.

Adding Your Launchpad in Reason (Mac and Windows)

1. Start Reason and open *Settings*, then the *MIDI* page.

2. Under *Remote keyboards and controllers*, click *Add manually*.

3. Choose manufacturer *Novation* and model *Launchpad Pro [MK3]*.

4. Set the ports. The codec needs **both** input ports:

   - Input (LPProMK3 MIDI) → the Launchpad's MIDI port
   - Input (LPProMK3 DAW) → the Launchpad's DAW port
   - Output (LPProMK3 MIDI) → the Launchpad's MIDI port

5. Click *OK*

6. Add a Launchnik device to your rack

7. Right-click on the Launchnik and select *Lock Novation Launchpad Pro [MK3] to this device*.

Updating the Remote Codec

Download the zip file of the latest release of the remote codec here:

- github.com/zapperment/rebridge/releases/download/lppmk3-latest/Launchpad-Pro-MK3-remote-codec-for-Launchnik.zip

Copy the new files over the old ones, as when installing. Either restart Reason or go to *Settings* → *MIDI* and switch the Launchpad's *Active* box off and on again.

Removing the Remote Codec

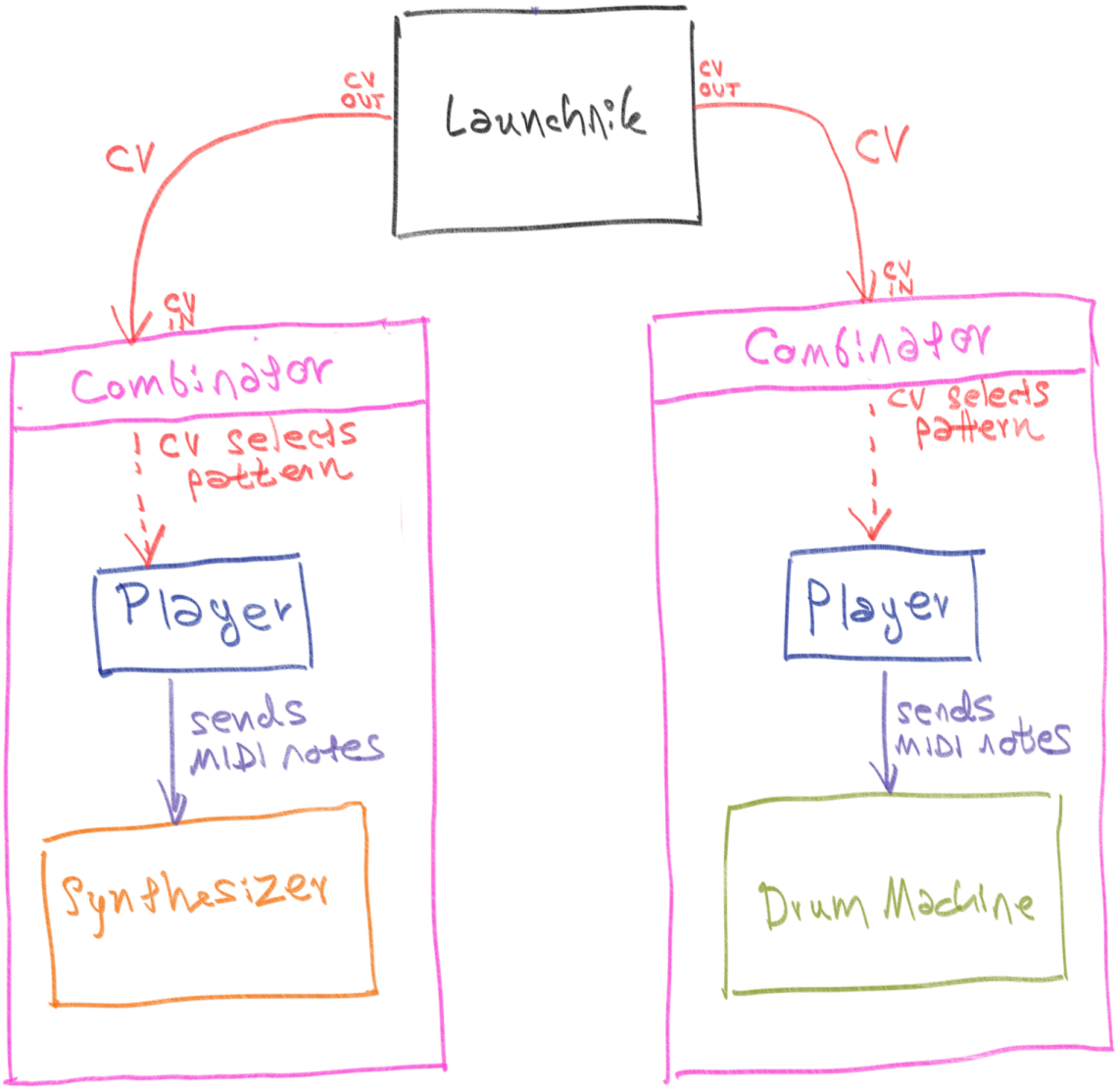
Remove the Launchpad in *Settings* → *MIDI*, quit Reason and delete the four LPPMK3 files.

Getting Started: Launchnik Basics

Launchnik is a utility device for the Reason rack. It actually doesn't do anything but emit CV voltages, albeit in a clever way. Lauchnik is not a sequencer, it does not play any notes by itself.

To perform a live session, you use Player devices that play notes on instruments like drum computers or synthesizers.

When you wrap the Player and the instrument in a Combinator, you can connect Launchnik with a CV cable to switch the Player's patterns or turn it off. Most Players do not support controlling patterns via CV directly, hence the workaround with the Combinator.



Launchnik comes with a demo song *Demo 1 — Synth and Drums.reason* that shows what a basic example as we see in the diagram above could look like in Reason:

CV cable connections between the devices on the back of the rack:

In Launchnik, the column of red buttons on the left controls the pattern of a PolyStep sequencer, which plays a Europa synthesizer.

The column of pink buttons on the right controls the pattern of a Drum Sequencer, which plays a Kong drum machine.

We call the eight columns of buttons that Launchnik has **tracks**.

Each of the eight buttons of each track causes the connected Player to switch to a different pattern. We call these parts **clips**. Each of the tracks can have up to eight clips.

With this very simple setup, we can already get pretty creative!

Load the song *Demo 1 — Synth and Drums.reason* and start Reason's transport, either by hitting the play button on your Launchpad or clicking the play button in Reason.

At first, you hear nothing, which is expected — all the tracks in Launchnik are off.

While Reason is playing, hit the button for *Pattern 1* on the track *Synthesizer*.

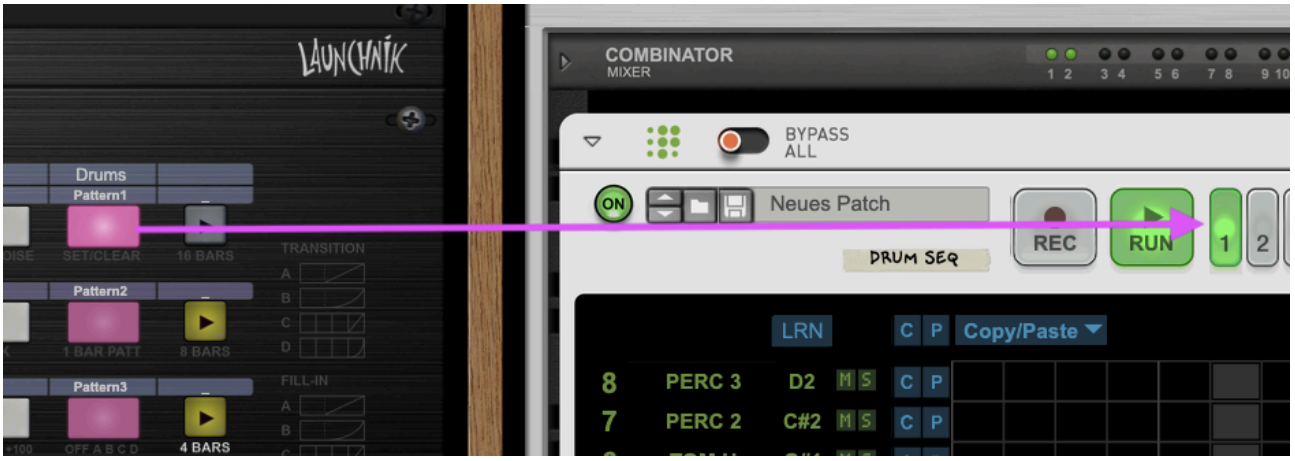
Notice how the PolyStep that controls the Europa in the Combinator on the left doesn't play immediately, but at the start of the next 4 bar interval.

The clip *Pattern 1* is queued until the next interval switch point, indicated by a blinking button.

Then the clip, i.e. the PolyStep sequencer, starts playing and the button is lit permanently.

Now hit the *Pattern 2* button. At the next switch point, the PolyStep switches to pattern 2.

Now add a beat to get your live set moving! Hit the pink button *Pattern 1* on the *Drums* track. The kick drum starts at the next switch point.



Now let's try launching pattern 4 on the synth track and the drums track simultaneously. That is what the buttons on the far right are for. We call each row of buttons a **scene**, and the buttons with the arrows on the right the scene buttons.

Click on the scene button *Let's go!* or tap the corresponding button on your Launchpad. *Pattern 4* clips on both tracks start blinking, and at the next switch point, get a groove on.

There you have it, this is how you perform a Launchnik live session. Try out some variations by launching various scenes and clips.

This is just the tip of the iceberg! Launchnik has much more to offer, as we will see in the next chapters...

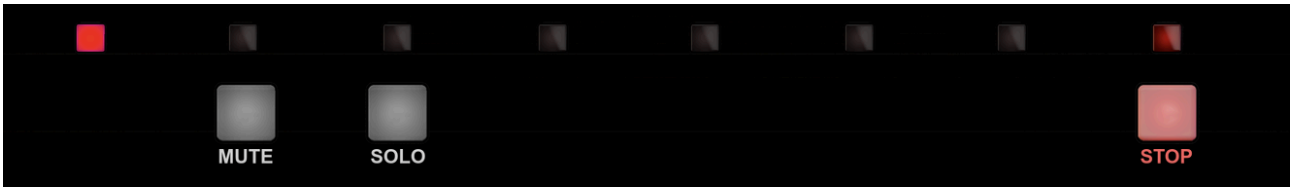
Track Functions: Stop, Mute and Solo

Below the columns of launch buttons, each track has a smaller button that has various uses, depending on which function is currently selected.

Stopping Tracks

By default, the function *STOP* is selected. In this track function mode, the function buttons are coloured red.

In this mode, you can stop tracks that are playing clips. As when launching clips, this happens in time with your music, at the next switch point.



- Tracks that are currently playing a clip and thus can be stopped have their function button lit up red; in the example above, this is track 1, on the left
- Tracks that are currently not playing a clip, but do contain at least one clip, are lit very dimly; in the example above, this is track 8, on the right
- Tracks that have no clips have dark function buttons to show that the function has no effect on them (tracks 2-7 in the example above)

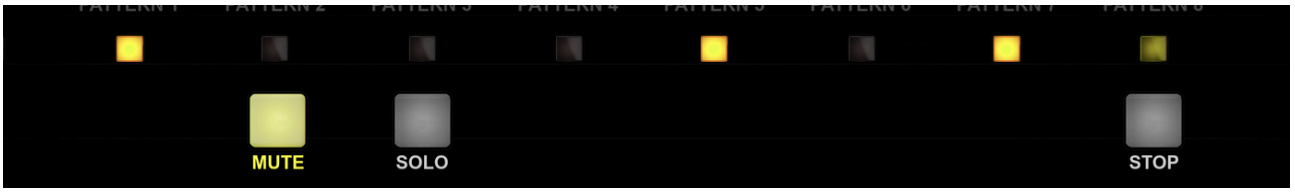
> ***Try it out!*** *Load the demo song* ***Demo 1 — Synth and Drums.reason*** *in Reason (stand-alone DAW). Start Reason's transport by hitting the play button on your Launchpad or clicking the play button in the Reason window. Launch a clip on track 1 or 8 and wait for it to start playing. Then hit a stop button on your Launchpad or on Launchnik. The track stops playing at the next switch point.*

Muting Tracks

Click the function button *MUTE*, or hit the corresponding button on your Launchpad to enter mute mode. In this track function mode, the function buttons are coloured yellow.

Use mute to temporarily turn off tracks, which is a common technique to create tension before the next part of a live session. For example, turn off the beat for a bar or so before you drop the bass.

Muted tracks automatically get unmuted and start playing again at the next switch point.



- Tracks that are currently playing a clip and thus can be muted have their function button lit up yellow; in the example above, these are track 1,5, 7 and 8
- Tracks that are currently muted, are lit very dimly; in the example above, this is track 8
- Tracks that have no clips have dark function buttons to show that the function has no effect on them (tracks 2, 3, 4 and 6 in the example above)

> ***Try it out!*** *Load the demo song* ***Demo 2 — Four Tracks.reason*** *in Reason (stand-alone DAW). Start Reason's transport by hitting the play button on your Launchpad or clicking the play button in the Reason window. Enter mute mode with the MUTE button. Launch scene 1, "Intro" and wait for it to start playing. Launch scene 4, "Let's go". While the clips of scene 4 are blinking (to indicate they are about to play), when the last bar of the interval starts, mute track 8, to briefly turn off the drums for a nice break effect.*

Soloing Tracks

Click the function button *SOLO*, or hit the corresponding button on your Launchpad to enter solo mode. In this track function mode, the function buttons are coloured blue.

Use solo to temporarily turn off all tracks except the soloed one. Similar to muting, this is another common technique to create tension before the next part of a live session. For example, create a break with only percussion playing.

Soloed tracks automatically get un-soloed at the next switch point, and the other tracks start playing again.

- Tracks that are currently soloed have their function button lit up blue; in the example above, this is 7
- Tracks that have at least one clip and thus can be soloed have their buttons dimly lit blue; in the example above, tracks 1, 5 and 8
- Tracks that have no clips have dark function buttons to show that the function has no effect on them (tracks 2, 3, 4 and 6 in the example above)

> ***Try it out!*** *Load the demo song* ***Demo 2 — Four Tracks.reason*** *in Reason (stand-alone DAW). Start Reason's transport by hitting the play button on your Launchpad or clicking the play button in the Reason window. Enter solo mode with the SOLO button. Launch scene 1, "Intro" and wait for it to start playing. Launch scene 4, "Let's go". While the clips of scene 4 are blinking (to indicate they are about to play), when the last bar of the interval starts, solo track 7, to briefly turn off all the tracks except percussion for a nice break effect.*

Three Modes of CV Output

Each of the eight tracks has six CV outputs, each of which can be set to one of three modes. This chapter discusses which mode does what.

Pattern Mode

So far, we have used only one of the six CV outputs that are available, in pattern mode.

In the screenshot above, the track *LoveLetters* sends pattern CV to a PolyStep sequencer, the track *SyncPop* sends pattern CV to a Bassline Sequencer, the track *Bongos* sends pattern CV to a Dr. Octo Rex loop player, and the track *DeepHouse* sends pattern CV to a *Drum Sequencer*.

When in pattern CV mode, the CV outputs send nine discrete values: value 0 turns off the pattern of a Player device, and values 16, 32, 48, 64, 80, 96, 112 and 127 to select patterns 1-8.

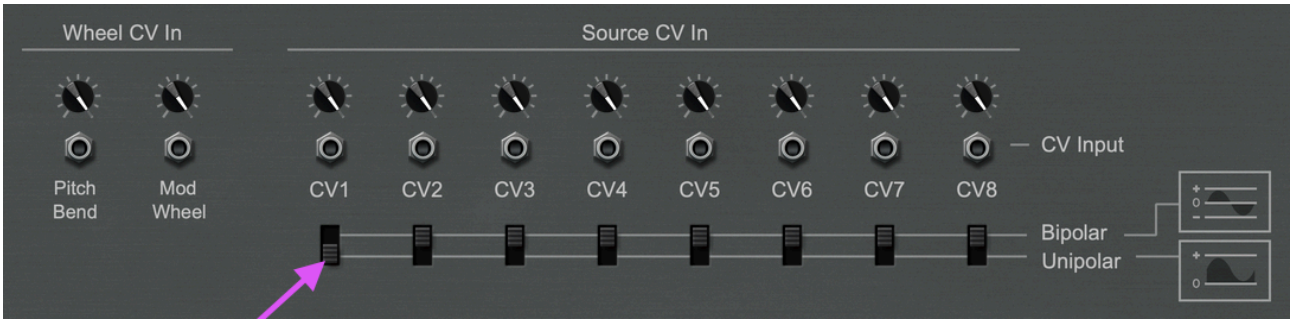
Connecting a Player to a Pattern CV Output

Most Player devices allow you to program up to eight patterns. However, they have no CV input to control the selected pattern. To control the pattern with Launchnik, we have to put the player and the instruments it is playing in a Combinator. The simplest way to do it is to select the player and other devices you want to combine and selecting “Combine” from the edit menu or context menu (see Reason manual: Creating a Combinator by combining devices).

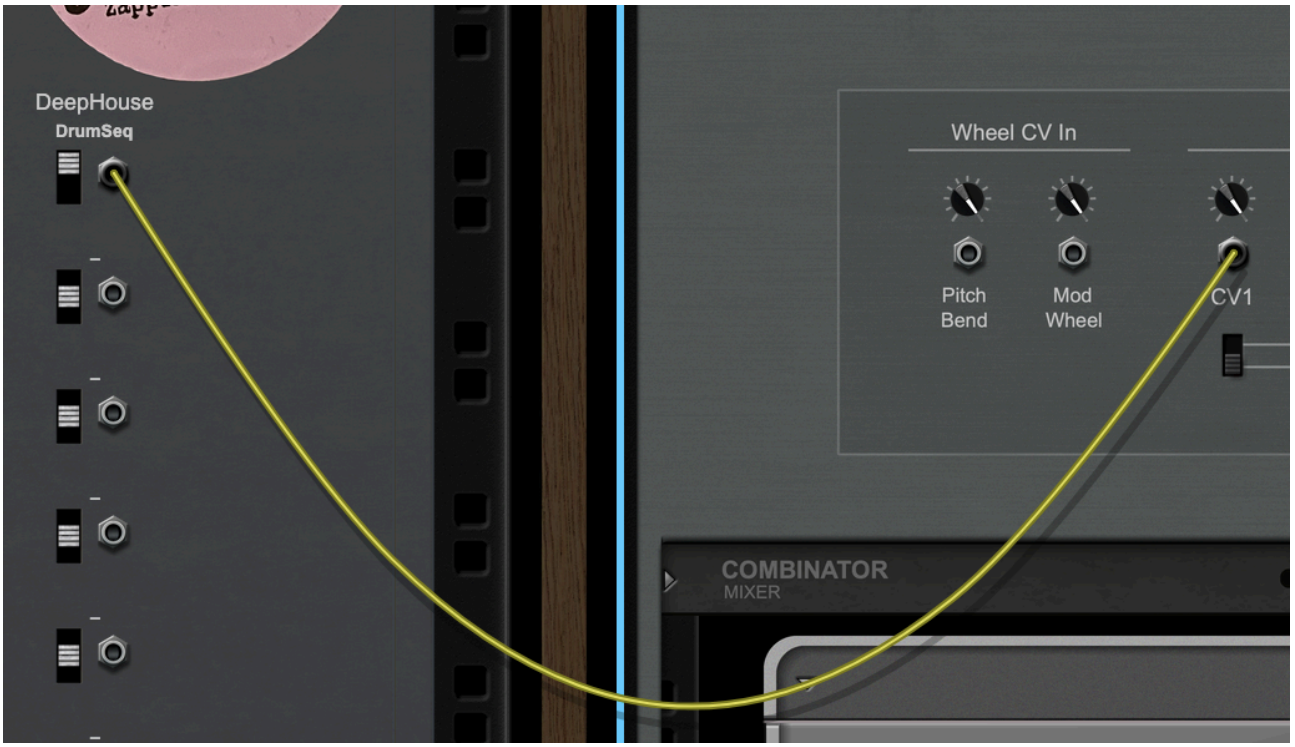
Flip the rack by hitting the tab key on your computer keyboard, to view the back of Launchnik and the Combinator you want to connect:

Click the *Editor* button on the back of the Combinator to view the *Source CV In* jacks:

Important! Switch the *Source CV In* you want to connect to *Unipolar* mode on the Combinator, otherwise pattern selection will *not* work properly:

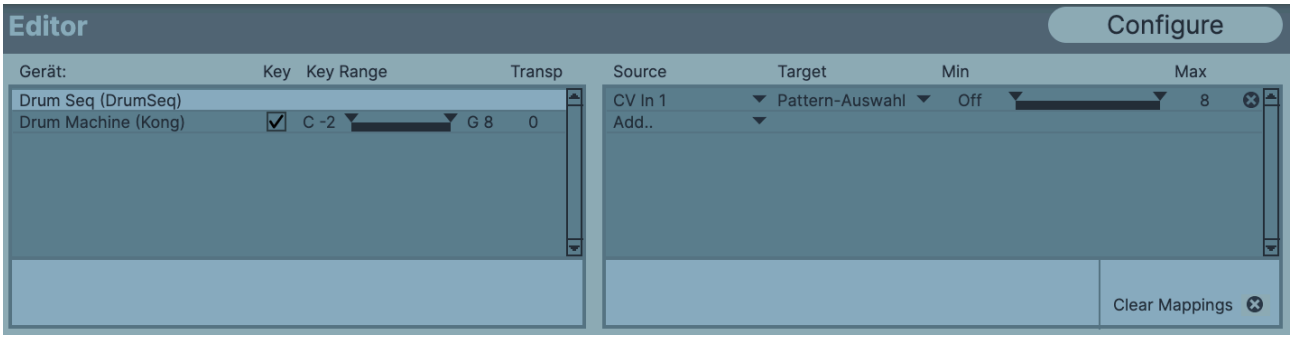


Connect the Combinator's CV input to Launchnik's CV output:



Make sure the CV output mode switch of Launchnik's CV output is set to the top position, which is pattern mode (the top CV outputs are set to pattern mode by default):

Flip the rack again with the tab key to access the Combinator's editor panel (see Reason manual).



Select the Player you want to control with Launchnik (in the example above, a Drum Sequencer).

Set *Source* to *CV In 1* and set *Target* to *Pattern Selection*. *Min* and *Max* values can stay as they are in most cases.

You can now use Launchnik to control the pattern your Player is playing!

> ***Try it out:*** *Load the Reason song* ***Demo 3 — Pattern Mode.reason****. It has a Launchnik already connected to a Combinator with a Drum Sequencer, playing a Kong drum machine. Start Reason's transport by hitting the play button on your Launchpad or clicking the play button in the Reason window. Launch one of the clips on track eight (pink column on the right) by hitting the corresponding button on your Launchpad or clicking the launch button on the Launchnik panel. Switch the playing pattern in time by launching other clips. Stop the pattern using the red stop button at the bottom.*

Connecting a Player That Does Not Have Patterns to a Pattern CV Output

Some Player devices, like the BeatMap or the Quad Note Generator, do not allow you to program different patterns. If this is the case, it makes sense to connect the Launchnik pattern CV output to the *On* button of the device. Then you can at least start and stop the device with Launchnik.

To do this, there is one little trick you need to know: Restrict the *Source Range* in the Combinator's editor to 0% to 13% (CV value 16). This way, clips playing patterns 1-8 in Launchnik will turn the device on, and stopping a track will turn it off.

Connecting a Dr. Octo Rex to a Pattern CV Output

Connecting a Dr. Octo Rex to a Launchnik works mostly the same way as connecting a Player device, as discussed previously. You wrap it in a Combinator, set the Combinator's *Source CV In* you want to connect to unipolar and drag a CV cable over to a CV output on Launchnik's back panel, which is in pattern mode (mode switch in top position).

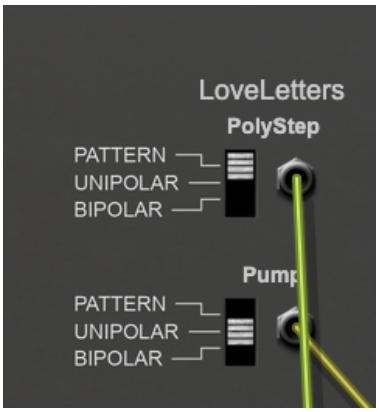
In the Combinator's editor, select the Dr. Octo Rex device, set *Source* to the CV input you are using and set *Target* to *Loop Slot*.

Unipolar Mode

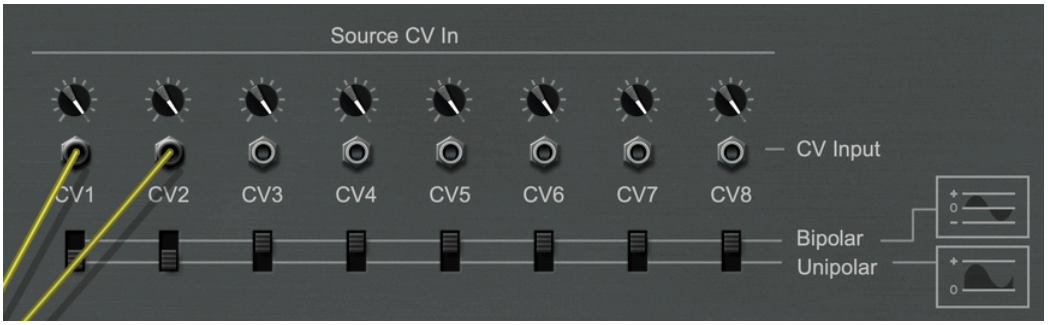
Besides pattern mode, each of the six CV outputs per track can be switched to unipolar mode. By default, all CV outputs except the top row are set to unipolar mode.

In unipolar mode, clips emit CV values in the range from 0 to 127.

This is useful to directly control all kinds of parameters on connected rack devices, enabling us to vary the sound of each clip in a track.

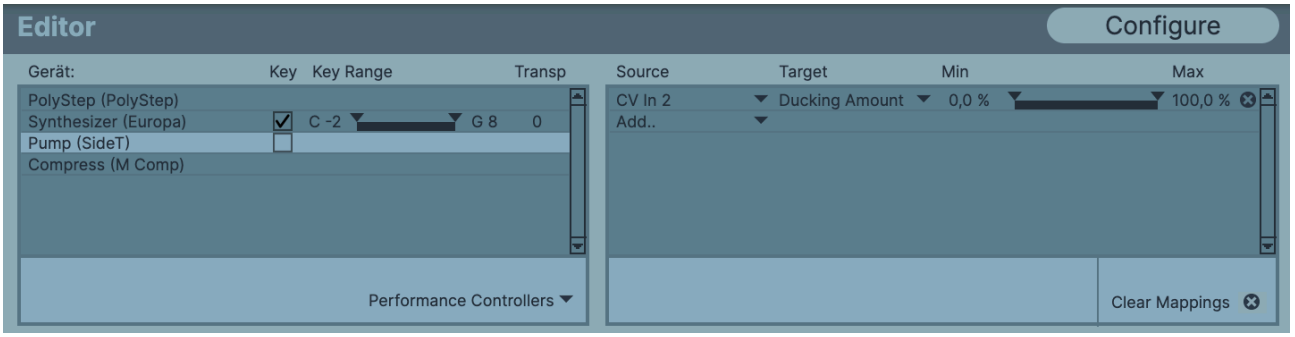


In the example above, the track *LoveLetters*, sends CV values from its second output (besides sending pattern CV from the first), to control the ducking amount of a Sidechain Tool device, to add that popular “pumping” effect.



The unipolar CV output is connected to CV input 2 on a Combinator (next to CV1, which receives pattern CV).

Important! As with the pattern CV, switch the mode of the CV input you connect to unipolar mode on the Combinator.



In the Combinator’s editor screen, select the device you want to control from Launchnik (in the example above, *SideT* i.e. Sidechain Tool).

Select the CV input of the Combinator that is connected to your Launchnik's unipolar output and choose a parameter to control (in the example, *CV In 2* and *Ducking Amount*).

Try it out: *Load the Reason song* ***Demo 4 — Unipolar Mode.reason****. It has a Launchnik already connected to a Combinator with a PolyStep sequencer, playing a Europa synth. The audio outputs of the synthesizer are connected to a Sidechain Tool. Start Reason's transport by hitting the play button on your Launchpad or clicking the play button in the Reason window. Launch the first clip of the track LoveLetters (top of the red column on the left) by hitting the corresponding button on your Launchpad or clicking the launch button on the Launchnik panel. Clip 1 has the CV value set to 0. Switch to pattern 2, which has CV set to 83%, and hear Europa start pumping at the next switch point.*

Bipolar Mode

The last of the three CV output modes is bipolar mode. Bipolar outputs emit CV values in the range from -127 to +127.

While unipolar mode is useful for controlling parameters directly, bipolar is perfect when you want to trim a value that is controlled elsewhere.

For example, you may have a knob on your MIDI keyboard to control a synth's filter cutoff frequency. You just love to go wild twisting the cutoff knob during your live performances, but it also makes sense to nudge the cutoff automatically up or down depending on which clip is playing.

The Combinator's *Control CV In* inputs allow you to do this, if you connect them to a Launchnik CV output that is in bipolar mode.

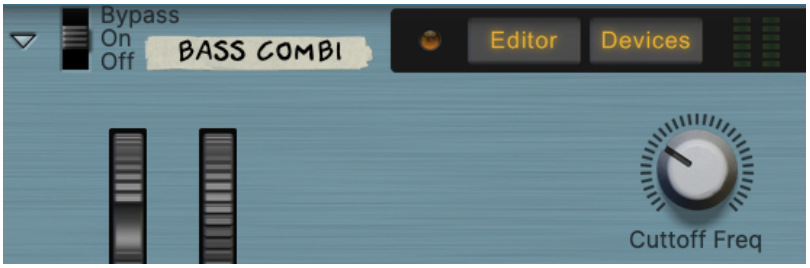
In the example above, the first Launchnik CV output emits pattern values for a Bassline Generator, which plays a Monotone Bass Synthesizer.

The CV output below emits unipolar values to influence the filter cutoff frequency of the Monotone.

The Launchnik bipolar CV out is connected to the *Control CV In* on a Combinator that wraps the Bassline Generator and the Monotone synth.

Note how the little trim pot to the left of the CV input is set to about 50%. In most cases, you want to do this, to make the influence of the Launchnik clips more subtle.

In the dropdown next to the CV input, *Cutoff Freq* is selected. This refers to a control on the Combinator's front panel (which you can map to a knob on your MIDI keyboard):



In the Combinator's editor, the source *Cutoff Freq* is mapped to the parameter *Filter Freq* of the Monotone:

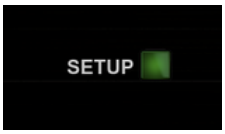
Try it out: *Load the Reason song* ***Demo 5 — Bipolar Mode.reason****. It has a Launchnik already connected to a Combinator with a Bass Sequencer, playing a Monotone synth. The filter cutoff of the Monotone is controlled by a knob on the Combinator's front panel. Start Reason's transport by hitting the play button on your Launchpad or clicking the play button in the Reason window. Launch the first clip of the track SyncPop (top of the cyan column in the middle) by hitting the corresponding button on your Launchpad or clicking the launch button on the Launchnik panel. Clip "Subdued" has the CV value set to -66%. Then switch to pattern "Medium" (-33%), then "FullThrottle" (0%), then "Busy" (+33%) and hear the bass sound get increasingly sharp and aggressive. You can use the knob on the Combinator to turn it up even more!*

Setup Mode — Configuring Clips

So far, we have discussed how to play live sessions with Launchnik, how to launch clips and scenes, how to stop, mute and solo them, and how to connect Launchnik to other rack devices.

The crucial part that is missing so far is, of course: How exactly do you configure the clips of each track to emit the CV values you need? The answer is, you've guessed it: Setup mode.

You enter setup mode by clicking the small green setup button on the lower left of Launchnik's front panel, or by tapping the corresponding button on your Launchpad.



Pick Clip

The first step of setup mode is to select the clip you want to configure. This step is called *PICK CLIP*.

After hitting *SETUP*, all the launch buttons on the front panel and all the pads on your Launchpad start flashing white, prompting you to pick a clip:

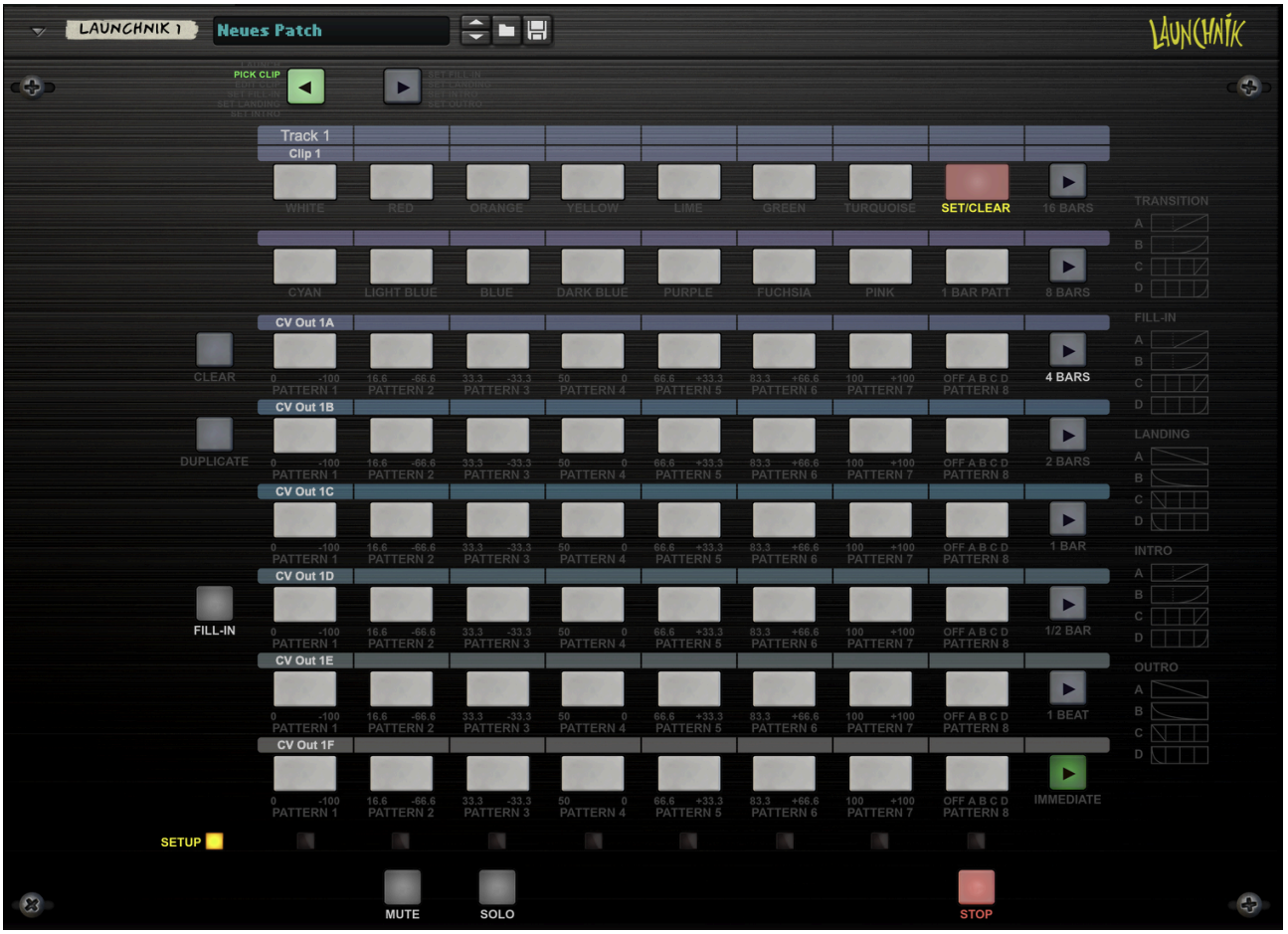
To help you navigate, each setup step has its own colour. The pick clip step is green, as indicated by the colour of the setup button and label, the Launchnik logo on the upper right, and the Novation logo on your Launchpad.

Note how the back button on the upper left turns white and shows the label *LAUNCH*. You can use it to get back to launch mode. The colour of launch mode is white.

Pick a clip by clicking a launch button or tapping a pad on your Launchpad.

Edit Clip

You are now at setup step 2, *EDIT CLIP* mode.

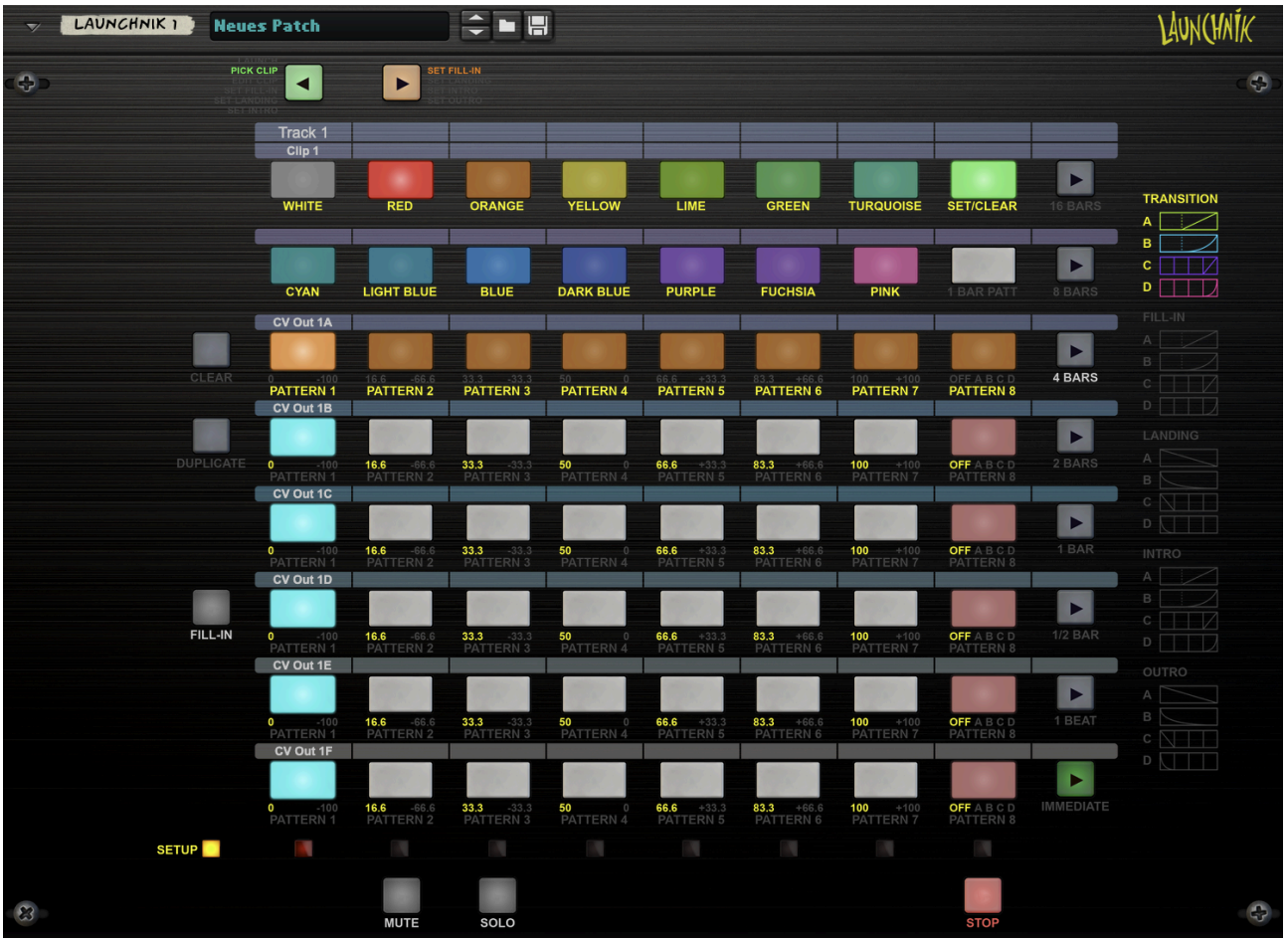


The edit clip step is yellow, as indicated by the colour of the setup button and label, the Launchnik logo on the upper right, and the Novation logo on your Launchpad.

The back button gets you back to the previous step. It is green and shows the label *PICK CLIP*. You can go back to launch mode by clicking / tapping the *SETUP* button to exit setup.

The screenshot above shows an empty clip in edit clip mode.

You can activate a clip using the red *SET/CLEAR* button on the upper right:



The *SET/CLEAR* button turns green, indicating the clip is no longer empty.

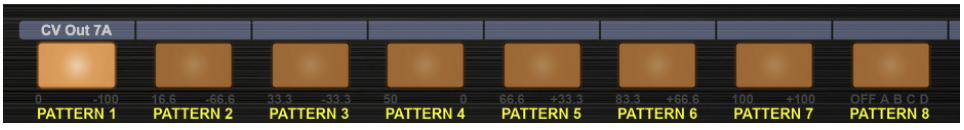
Setting the Clip Colour

Use the first two rows of buttons to set the clip's colour to your liking. Each track has a default colour: track 1 is red, track 2 orange, track 3 yellow, track 4 green, track 5 cyan, track 6 blue, track 7 purple, track 8 pink.

Setting Patterns

Rows 3 to 8 are for setting the value of the six CV outputs.

The first CV output is, per default, in pattern mode. Buttons to select patterns are orange. By default, clip 1 is set to pattern 1, clip 2 to pattern 2, 3 to 3, etc.

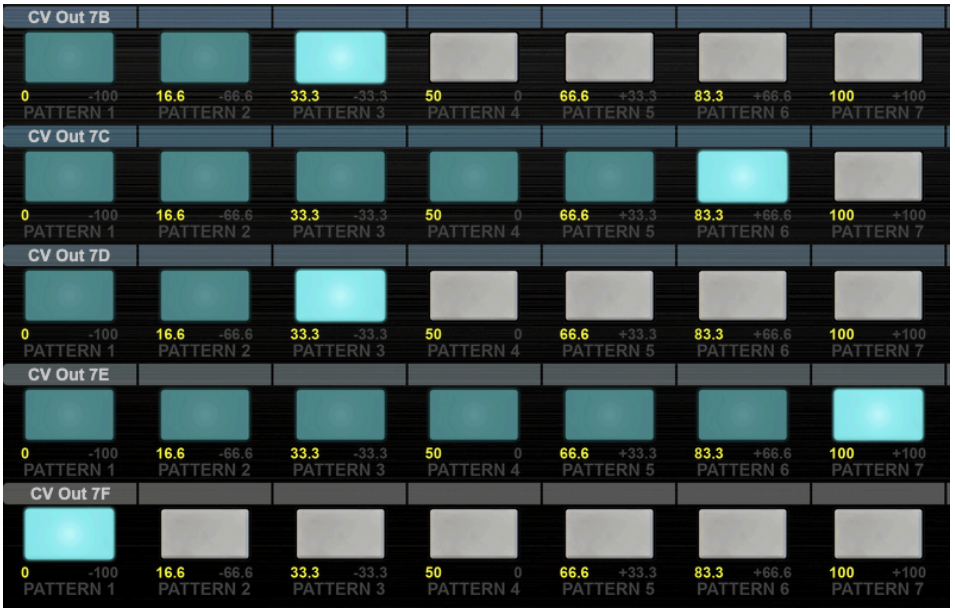


You do not have to adhere to the defaults — you can assign the same pattern to multiple clips. Using the output mode selection switches on the back panel, you can change the CV output mode

of the first output to unipolar or bipolar, or have more than one output in pattern mode, or no pattern output at all. It's up to you!

Setting Unipolar Values

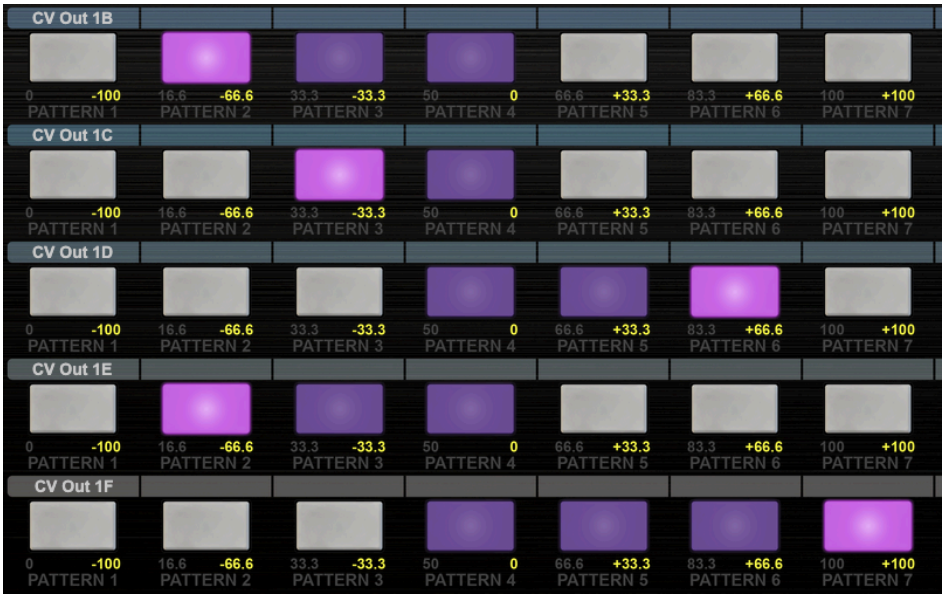
The other five CV outputs are, per default, unipolar. The buttons to set unipolar values are turquoise. You can set the CV value in seven steps, from 0% to 100%:



Setting Bipolar Values

You can change the mode of these outputs to bipolar (or even pattern, as discussed above).

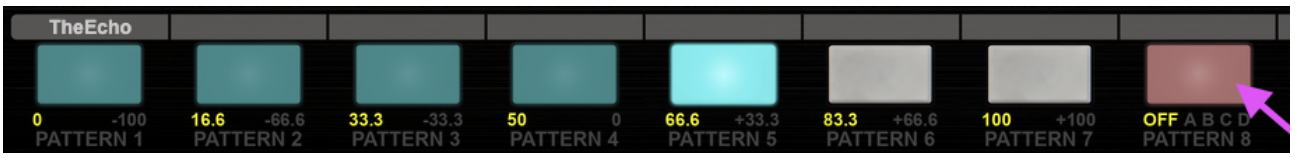
The buttons to set bipolar values have the colour fuchsia. You can set the CV value in seven steps, from -100% to +100%, with 0% in the middle.



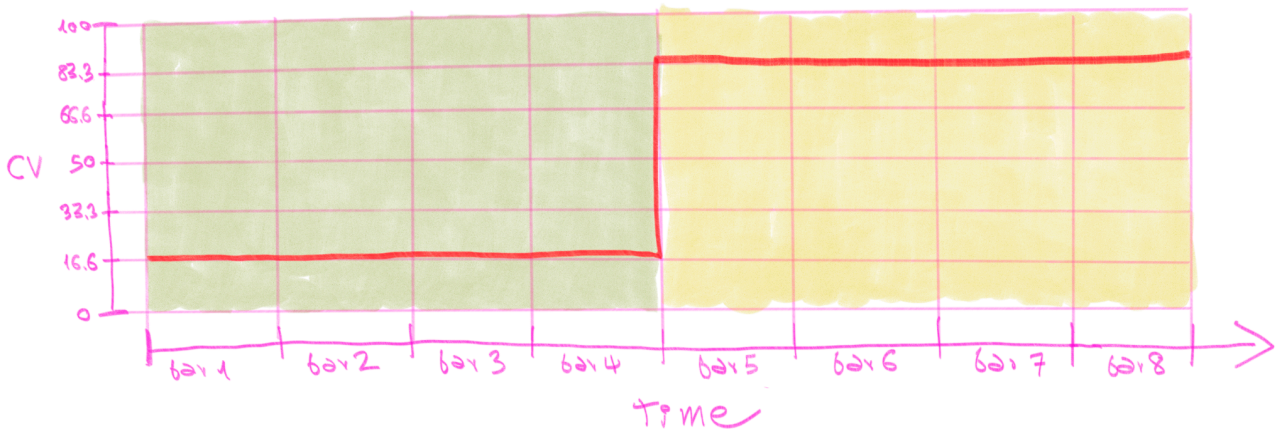
Setting Transitions

You have probably noticed that while there are eight patterns to choose from, unipolar and bipolar values only allow you to set seven value increments. The eighth button in each row for setting these values controls the value's transition.

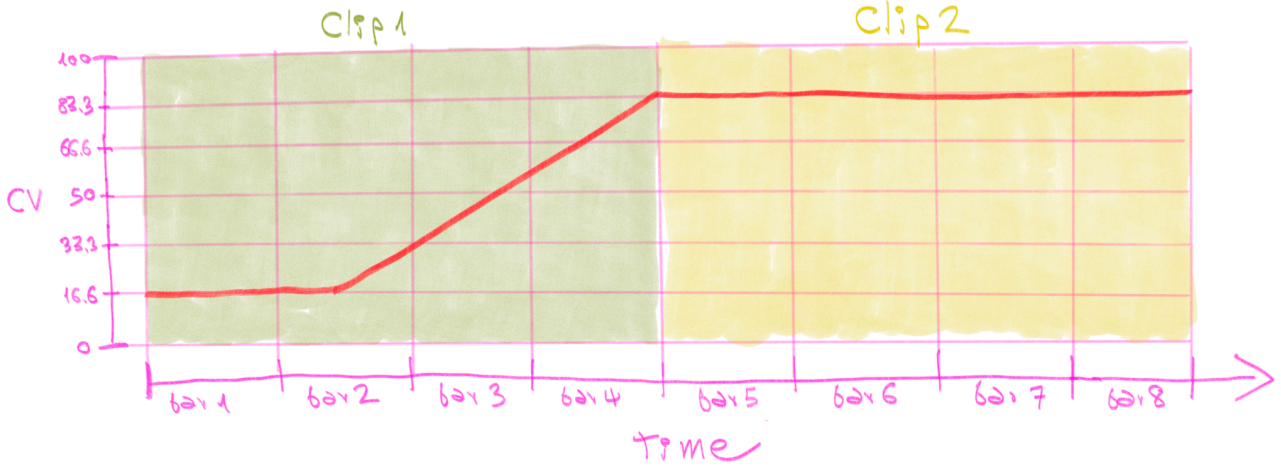
By default, the transition button is red, which means transition is turned off:



Transition off means that, when Launchnik switches from one clip to another, the CV setting jumps directly from the value configured for the first clip to that of the next:

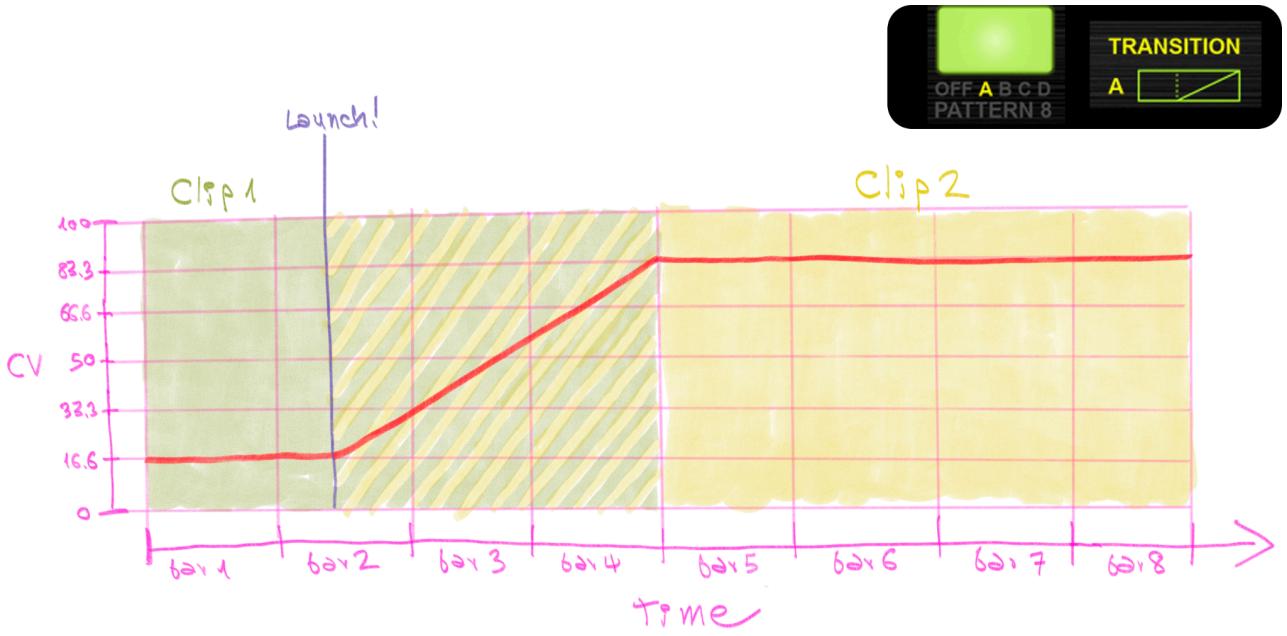


Transitions allow you to influence this behaviour, to make the CV value of the playing pattern gradually move towards the value of the queued pattern:

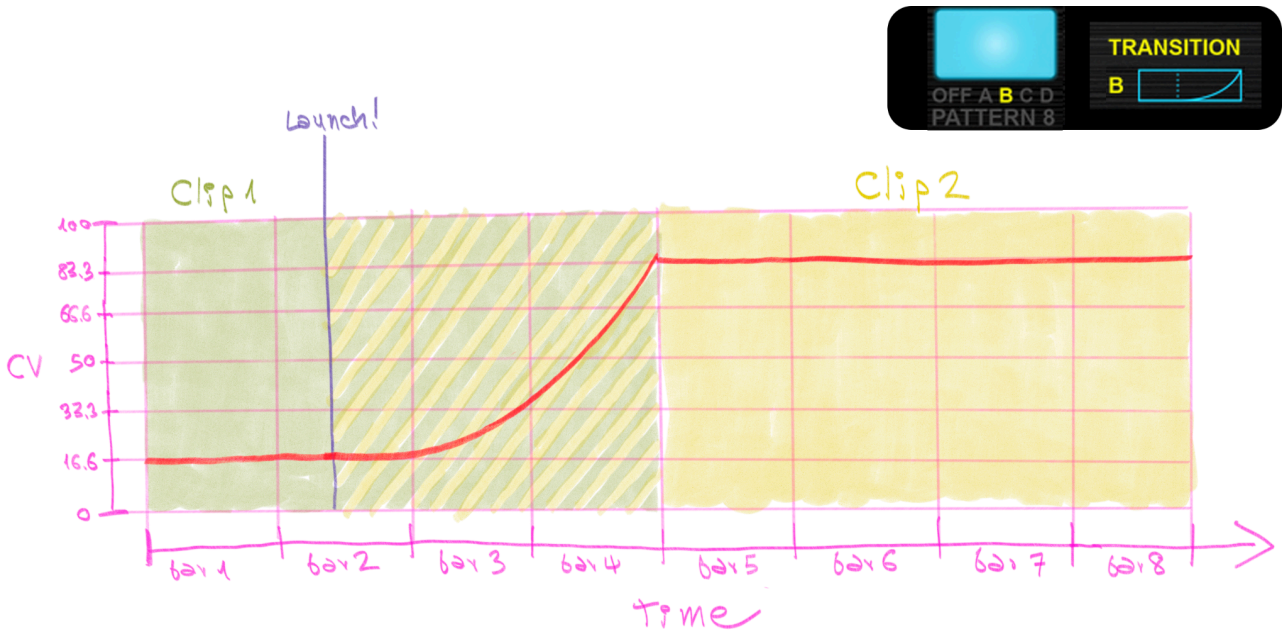


Hit the transition button to cycle through the four modes of transition.

This diagram illustrates transition mode A: The CV value starts moving towards the value of the next clip in a linear slope, at the precise moment when you launch the next clip.

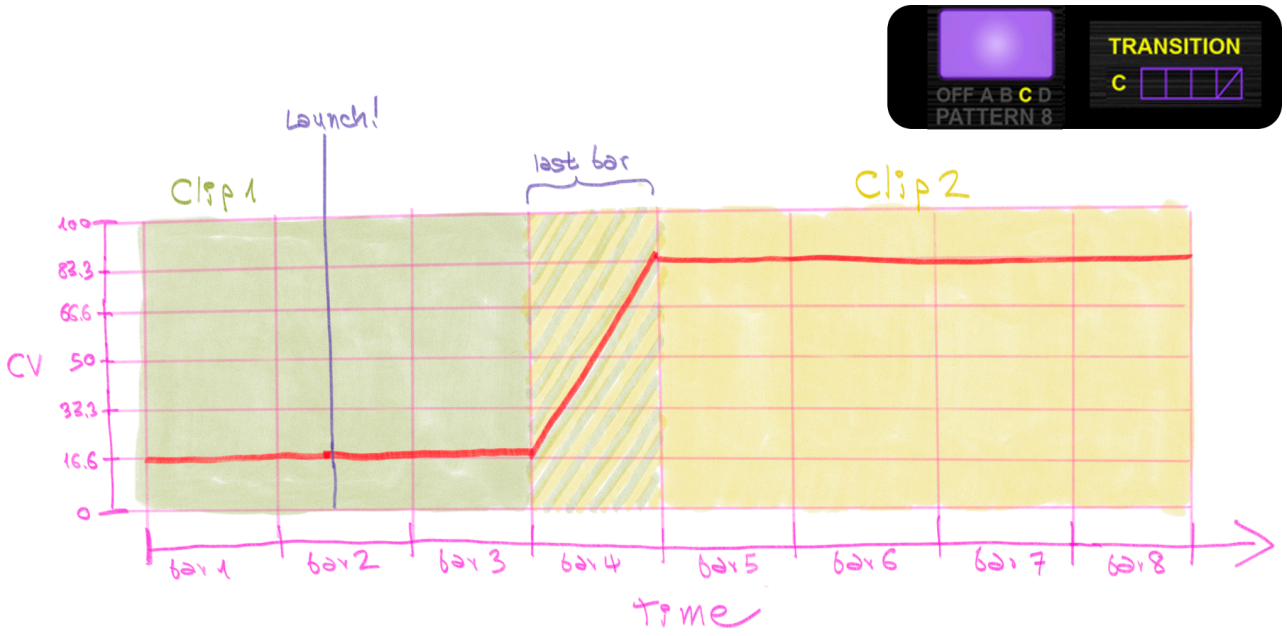


Transition mode B also starts the transition instantly when the next clip is launched. However, it uses an exponential curve, which may feel somewhat more natural:

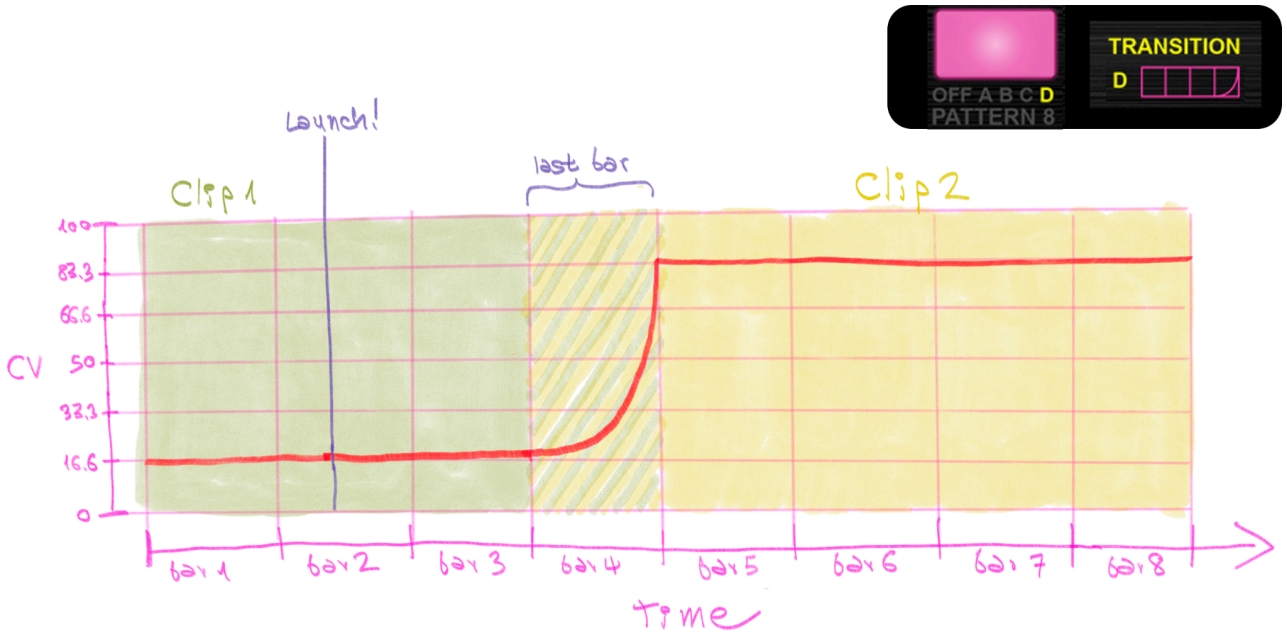


Transition modes C and D do not start the transition instantly, like A and B do, but only when the last bar before the clip switch starts.

Transition C has a linear transition curve during the last bar:



Transition D has an exponential transition curve during the last bar:

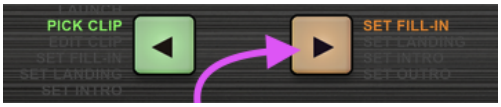


Try it out: *Load the Reason song* ***Love Letters from Launchnik.reason****. This is a complete live session with all the whistles and bells. Track 3, "AcidSeq" (yellow launch buttons) has three clips, "Soft", "Medium" and "Hard", with transition A turned on in all clips. Start the Reason transport, launch one of the clips, then another. Notice how the sound of the Thor acid sequencer line changes gradually in between clips. Try configuring other transition modes.*

Fill-Ins

Launchnik has a couple more tricks up its sleeve!

Once you have set up a clip's pattern, CV values and transitions in setup step 2, *EDIT CLIP*, you can use the button with the right arrow above the launch button grid to go on to step 3, *SET FILL-IN*:



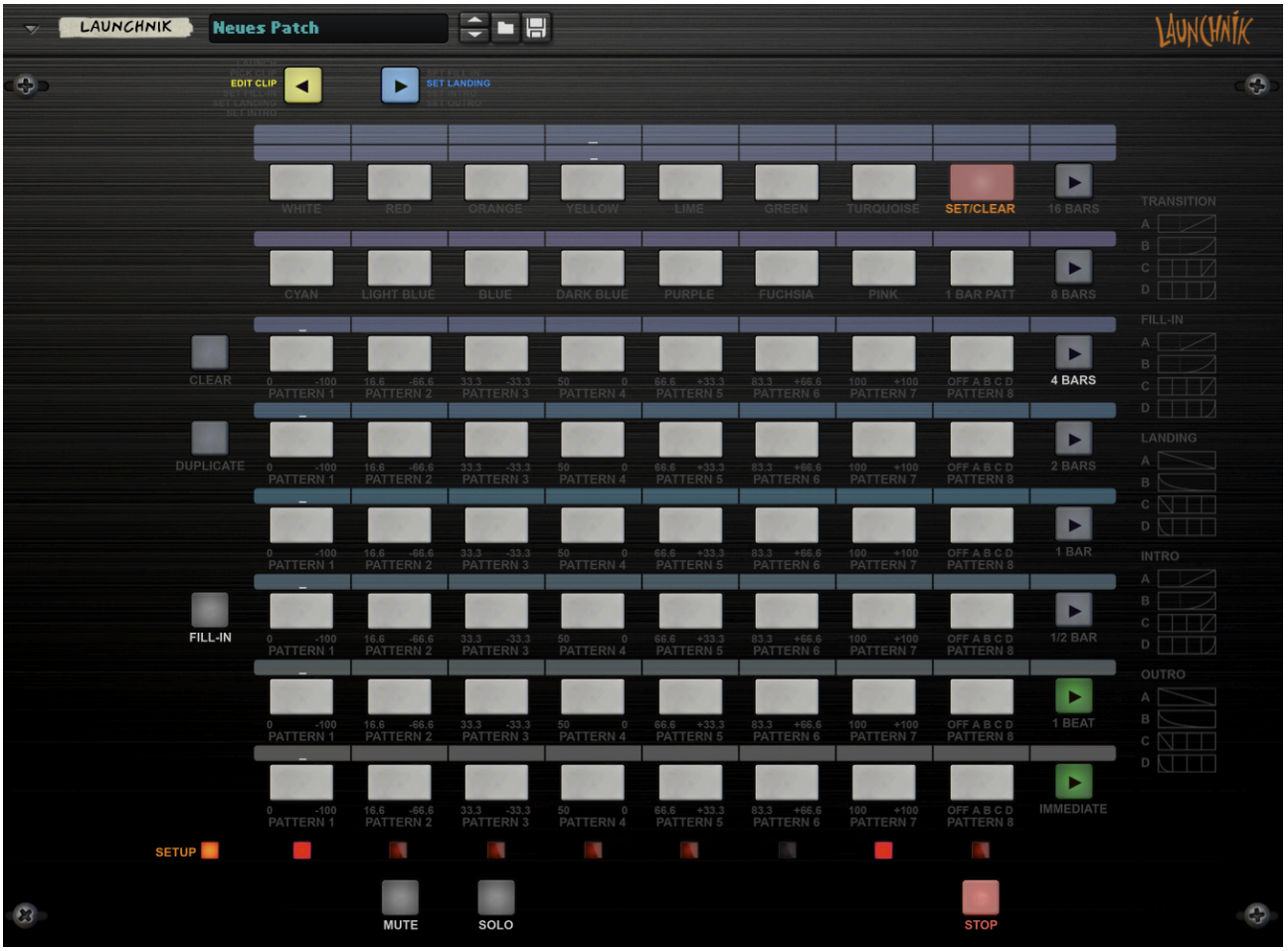
Fill-ins are a way to configure alternative colour, patterns and CV values that are applied when you use the fill-in button on the left:

> ***Please note:*** *On the Launchpad, the FILL-IN button is labelled "Fixed Length" — fill-ins are a feature that neither the stock Launchpad nor Ableton Live have, so we had to repurpose a button that at least starts with the same letter...*

When you hit the *FILL-IN* button, Launchnik immediately emits the values for patterns and bi- and unipolar CV values that you have configured for the fill-in. It keeps emitting them until the next switch-point.

This allows you, for example, to switch a Drum Sequencer pattern from the standard one to a pattern that has a snare drum roll. Or you can fill-in a uni- or bipolar CV value to crank up the filter cutoff/resonance for a dramatic effect. Or you can use pitch bend to increase the pitch towards the end of the interval, to create a "riser".

When you go to setup step 3, *SET FILL-IN*, a clip that has no fill-in configured yet shows mostly dark buttons, like an empty clip in step 2:



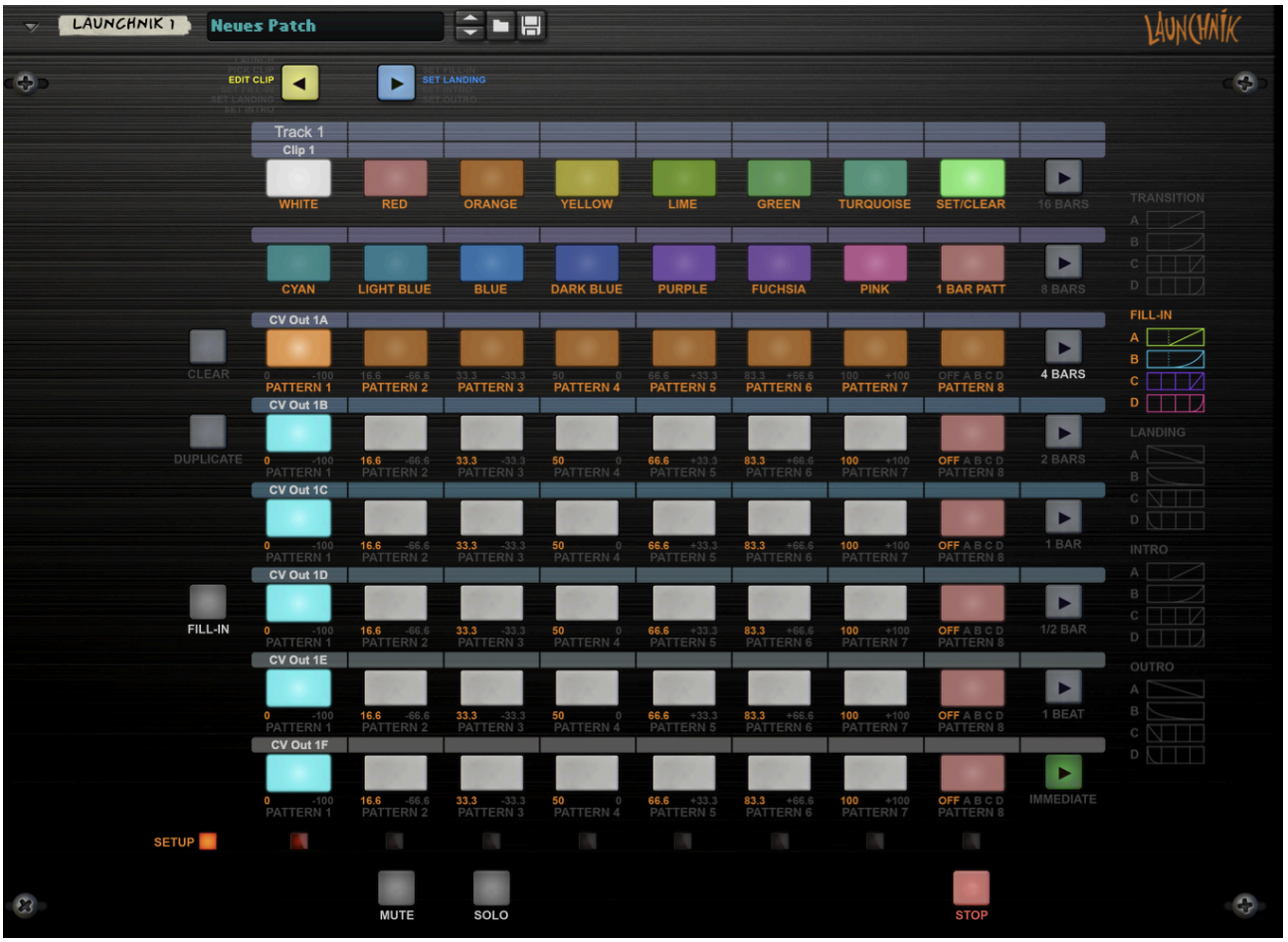
The set fill-in step is orange, as indicated by the colour of the setup button and label, the Launchnik logo on the upper right, and the Novation logo on your Launchpad.

The back button gets you back to the previous step. It is yellow and shows the label *EDIT CLIP*. The forward button is blue and gets you to the next setup step *SET LANDING* — more on that later…

Activate fill-in for the clip using the *SET/CLEAR* button.

> ***Before we discuss how to configure fill-ins, try it out:*** *Load the Reason song* ***Love Letters from Launchnik.reason****. Track 2, "Osc3Lead" (lime and orange launch buttons) has a clip "LoRiserFill" that pitches up the sound when filling in. Track 8, "DeepHouse" has drum fills on various clips.*

Hit the *SET/CLEAR* button to configure a fill-in for a clip. By default, when you turn on fill-in, the colour is set to white, and CV values are set to the same as you have set for the clip in the previous setup step.



If you want to, say, play a snare drum roll, you could switch to pattern 2 in fill-in setup and program pattern 2 accordingly in your drum sequencer.

One Special Twist You Need to Know: 1 BAR PATT

By default, Launchnik will switch to the fill-in pattern the instant you hit the fill-in button. If you want your drum roll to play only before the next switch point, at the end of the current interval, you will have to hit the fill-in button during the last bar, otherwise the drum roll may play too soon, and then multiple times.

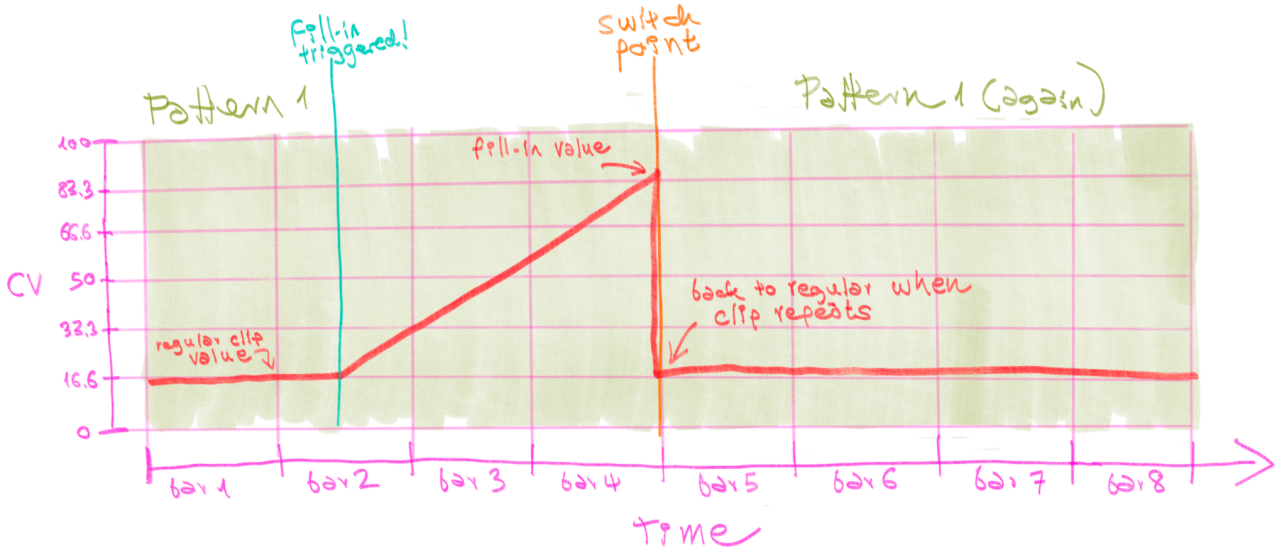
To make this easier, you can activate *1 BAR PATT* mode, using the button in row 2, column 8. When *1 BAR PATT* is active, the fill-in pattern will only play in the last bar of the current interval, regardless of when you hit the fill-in button.

Transitions of Unipolar and Bipolar Values During Fill-ins

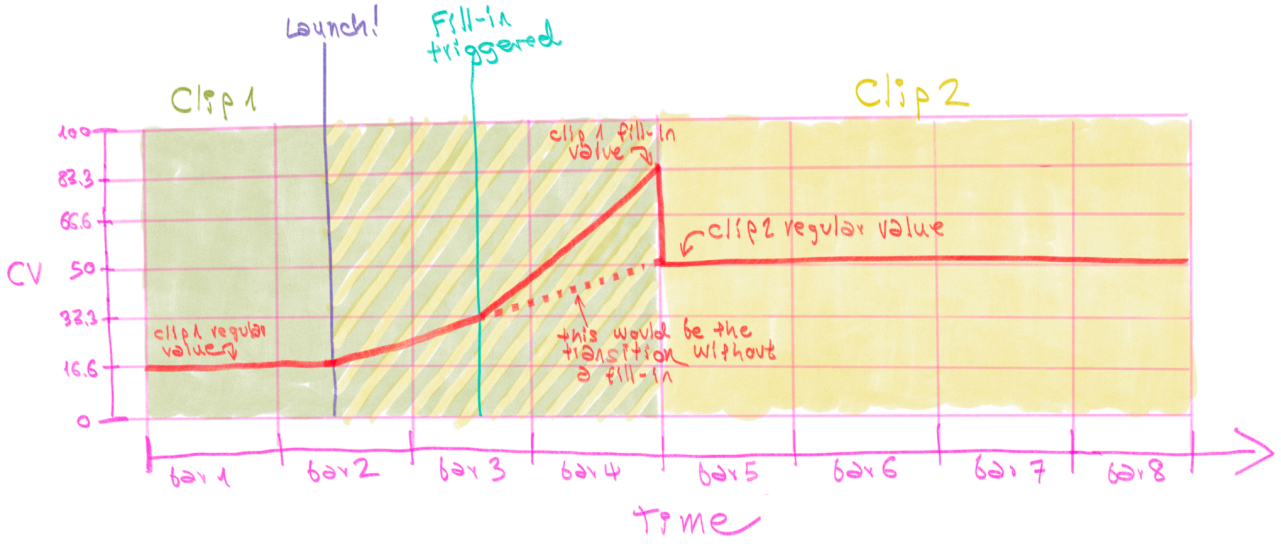
When you set a CV value to a different value than what is configured in the previous setup step, then the value will gradually move from the regular value towards the fill-in value, until it reaches the fill-in value at the end of the iteration, right before the switch point.

Depending on the transition mode, this happens in a linear fashion (transitions A and C) or in an exponential fashion (B and D). Transitions A and B start the fill-in transition immediately, while C and C execute the transition only in the last bar of the current switch interval.

This diagram shows how a unipolar CV value develops over time when a fill-in is triggered, with transition mode A:



Of course, you can combine launching another clip with a fill-in. Let's take a look at a complex example:



Clip 1 has 16.6 configured as regular value and 83.3 as fill-in value. Both have transition A (linear and immediate). Clip 2 has a regular value of 50. When you launch clip 2, the value starts

transitioning to the value of clip 2. When you trigger a fill-in, the value picks up at wherever the transition was at the time and transitions to the fill-in value until the end of the switch interval.

Landings

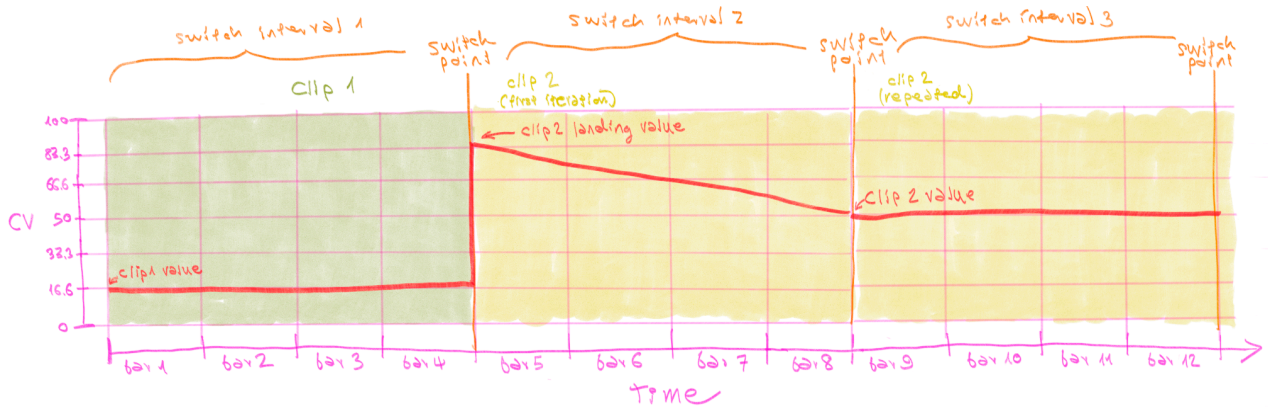
The next setup step, *SET LANDING, allows* you to create clips that, when they are playing their first iteration, emit different CV values than the regular clip setting, which is used in subsequent repetitions.

This is great, for example, for adding a sound effect or crash cymbal on the first downbeat of a pattern, to add some drama. Particular effective when combined with a fill-in leading up to the landing!

Landings are configured the same way as fill-ins. In contrast to fill-ins, landings are not triggered by any interaction from you, they play automatically when a clip starts, before it starts repeating.

Another difference is that *1 BAR PATT* affects the first bar of the switch interval, not the last.

Transitions always start at the beginning of the switch interval with the value configured for the landing and move towards the clip's regular value. The regular value is reached either at the next switch point (transitions A and B) or at the end of the first bar (transitions C and D).



> ***Try it out:*** *Load the Reason song* ***Love Letters from Launchnik.reason****. Track 8, "DeepHouse" has landings on the clips "Kick+Cl+HH" and "Full"*

Intros

The next setup step *SET INTRO,* allows you to configure patterns and CV voltages that are emitted *before* a clip starts playing. They only come into effect when the track was previously playing no clips. This is great for melodic phrases that don't start on the downbeat but have a couple of leading notes, or for fading in sounds.

The intro values are emitted immediately when you launch the clip (transitions A and B), or at the beginning of the last bar (transitions C and D). They start at the value you've configured for the intro, and move towards the regular value configured for the clip.

So, for a fade in, you could assign a CV output to an instrument's master volume. You set it to full in the regular clip setting and set it 0 in the intro, with one of the four transitions.

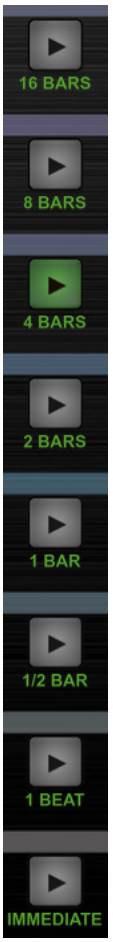
> ***Try it out:*** *Load the Reason song* ***Love Letters from Launchnik.reason****. Track 2, "Osc3Lead" has a fade-in intro on clip "Low"*

Outros

In the final setup step, *SET OUTRO*, you can configure patterns and CV voltages that are emitted *after* a clip stopped playing, and the track is not playing any clips anymore. It's the opposite of *SET INTRO*, basically.

> ***Try it out:*** *Load the Reason song* ***Love Letters from Launchnik.reason****. Track 2, "Osc3Lead" has a fade-out outro on clip "Low"*

Setting the Switch Interval Length



Setup step 1, the one you enter when you are in session mode and push the *SETUP* button, has one additional function besides picking a clip to edit:

It also allows you to configure the length of the switch interval.

By default, the switch interval is set to 4 bars.

In setup step 1, the scene buttons, i.e. buttons with arrows to the right of the launch button grid, act as selectors for the switch interval length.

Note that when you set the switch interval length to *IMMEDIATE*, there actually is no switch interval, because you switch from one clip to another the instant you hit a launch button.

Clearing and Duplicating Clips

The buttons *CLEAR* and *DUPLICATE* to the left of the launch button grid work similar to the setup mode in a sense that when you hit either one of them, Launchnik switches to *PICK CLIP* mode, prompting you to pick the clip you want to clear (=erase) or duplicate (=make a copy).

When you are duplicating, after picking a clip, you pick a launch button that you want the clip to be copied to.